

WEEK 3 OF 4 • Breath

Script 3: Box Breathing (Tactical Breathing)**Theme: Stress Regulation and Recovery**

Rationale: This technique lowers heart rate and cortisol levels, helping students regain control when they feel "hyper" or "upset." Used by elite soldiers and athletes to focus under pressure.

Request that students find their meditation stance. Remind students of the "out."

"Sometimes in training, or in life, our hearts start racing and we feel out of control. We can use a technique called 'Box Breathing' to hack our nervous system and force our bodies to calm down. This is used by elite soldiers and athletes to focus under pressure.

Settle into your stance. Picture a square box in your mind. We are going to travel around the four sides of the box using our breath. Each side of the box will take a count of four.

Side 1: Inhale through your nose for a count of 4... 3... 2... 1. Side 2: Hold that breath at the top for 4... 3... 2... 1. Side 3: Exhale slowly through your mouth for 4... 3... 2... 1. Side 4: Hold your lungs empty for 4... 3... 2... 1.

Let's do it again together. Inhale deeply (1, 2, 3, 4). Hold it (1, 2, 3, 4). Exhale completely (1, 2, 3, 4). Hold empty (1, 2, 3, 4).

Continue this rhythm on your own for three more rounds. Imagine tracing the shape of the square with your mind as you breathe. (Pause for 45 seconds.)

Feel how your heart rate has slowed down. You are in control. When you are ready, return to normal breathing and open your eyes."